

Cravings Fix Workbook

THE FIX for Cravings, sessions 1–3: the craving map, the toolkit, the recipes, the craving-date planner, the monthly audit, the relapse plan, and book prompts

Session 1 · Understanding and rewiring cravings

Highly palatable food engages the same wanting circuitry as other compulsive behaviours (Volkow et al., *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*); "eating addiction" describes the behaviour pattern (Hebebrand et al., *Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews*; Gearhardt's Yale Food Addiction Scale, *Appetite*); a high-glycemic meal produces a rebound of hunger and craving-centre activation four hours later (Lennerz et al., *AJCN*). Two roots, emotional and physical; the same plasticity that built the groove builds a new one, with repetition (Lally).

My craving map

MY CRAVING	WHEN (TIME / SITUATION)	ROOT: PHYSICAL (CRASH) · ENVIRONMENTAL (CUE) · EMOTIONAL (NEED) · SLEEP DEBT	THE MEAL OR MOMENT THAT SCHEDULES IT	THE REAL NEED, IF EMOTIONAL

The five strategies

#	STRATEGY	MY VERSION
1	The pause: "there it is" → 10-minute timer → hands busy (tea, water, three sighs, one text) → ride the wave (urge surfing)	
2	The swap that fixes the root: protein + fat + fiber at the meal <i>before</i> the craving hour; sweet only with protein and fat	
3	Change the cue: sweets out of sight; the show without the snack; the drive rerouted for two weeks	
4	Protect sleep: tonight's craving was scheduled by this morning's alarm (Greer et al.)	
5	The emotional root: "What do I actually need right now?" → give myself the real thing (rest, company, the journal)	

Two strategies I'll note (10 XP: apply one this week; upload a journal entry): 1. _____ 2. _____

Book prompts (Julia Ross, *The Craving Cure*, read alongside; supplement protocols go to your doctor first)

- Which craving type from her questionnaire fits my evenings, and which root here does it point to?
- What does her nutritional framing add to my swap strategy?
- What in her approach would I check with my doctor before trying?
- Cynthia's own writing on cravings: [title(s) to be inserted] — one idea I'll take from it: _____

Session 2 · Practical craving busters

The six-tool kit and the matching table

ROOT	FIRST TOOL	SECOND TOOL
Physical (the crash)	swap	move (5–15 min; brisk walking reduced chocolate cravings: Oh & Taylor, <i>Appetite</i>)
Environmental (the cue)	rearrange	sip something warm
Emotional (the need)	pause + "what do I need?"	connect (one text: "craving")
Sleep debt	earlier night	—

Herbal note: gentle teas (cinnamon, ginger, peppermint, chamomile, hibiscus, rooibos) are the only "remedy" with real evidence here. Supplements sold as craving cures have thin evidence; while trying to conceive they go to your doctor first, as does anything with licorice root.

The fix smoothie (serves 1)

1 cup plain whole-milk Greek yogurt or kefir (or unsweetened plant yogurt + unflavoured protein) · 1 tbsp unsweetened cocoa · 1 tbsp almond or peanut butter · ½ frozen banana or a handful of frozen cherries · handful of spinach · 1 tsp cinnamon · pinch of salt · ½ cup unsweetened milk · ice. Blend. ≈20 g protein; dessert that doesn't schedule tomorrow's craving.

The two-minute bowl

Greek yogurt · a spoon of cocoa stirred in · a spoon of nut butter on top · a few frozen cherries.

Craving-date planner (10 XP with the smoothie photo: discuss with your partner)

HARD EVENING	DATE IDEA (NON-FOOD, PHONES AWAY)	WHO PLANS IT	DONE
			☐
			☐
			☐

Ideas: walk with a thermos · board game or puzzle where the snacks used to be · bath with two mugs while the other reads aloud · sunset drive · ten minutes of warm touch (Module 6) · pottery / climbing / library · bed at nine with a book, together. Nobody says the word "craving."

Tracking (two weeks; then keep the two tools that are yours)

DATE	TIME	ROOT	TOOL USED	WAVE PASSED?
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

Session 3 · Long-term craving freedom

Higher glycemic load ↔ ovulatory infertility (Chavarro et al., *European Journal of Clinical Nutrition*); fast food ≥4×/week before conception ↔ longer time to pregnancy, fruit ≥3×/day ↔ faster (Grieger et al., *Human Reproduction*); low-GI diet improved insulin sensitivity and cycle regularity in PCOS (Marsh et al., *AJCN*); daily sugary drink ↔ ≈20% lower monthly fecundability in both partners (Hatch et al., *Epidemiology*). Stable blood sugar → stable insulin → clearer hormone signalling.

Monthly habit audit (first of the month)

MONTH	TOOLS I'M STILL USING	CUES THAT CREPT BACK	WHAT CHANGED IN MY LIFE	ONE ADJUSTMENT

My relapse plan (10 XP: complete and upload; share your fix success in the forum)

Marlatt's model: the slip is not the fall; the story told about the slip is (abstinence violation effect); self-compassion after a lapse reduces further eating (Adams & Leary). Perfection is a relapse risk; a plan for imperfection is protection.

PART	MINE
1. High-risk situations (the week before my period · travel · the night after a negative test · a visitor · _____)	
2. Early warning signs ("buying for guests" · skipping the walk twice · bedtime drifting past 11 · _____)	
3. Slip script (the exact sentence): "That was a slip, not a fall. I'll drink a glass of water and do the next thing on my plan."	
4. Reset : three tiny actions in the next 24 hours + the person I'll text "reset"	

Q&A notes (from Session 3)

Travel: pack the swaps, protein at breakfast, walk on arrival, lower the bar · Pre-period week: protein and fat at every meal, expect a bigger wave, no self-audit · Partner brings sweets: an "I" statement + a craving date · Sweeteners: keep the sweet expectation alive; sparkling water is the swap · Does it get easier: cravings get quieter, rarer, and stop meaning anything · A bad slip: the body clears; say the script, reset, text your person.

Freedom page

The two tools that are mine: _____ and _____ · My person: _____ · What a craving means to me now:

"You are not weak. You were wired, and wiring can be rewired."

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.